Body Type Count Comparison

New ChangeCars website vs the original changecars.co.za · 31 October 2026

Summary

Both websites show stock from the same source, DealerTrade. The body type counts differ for three reasons, explained below:

1. **Cars without photos.** DealerTrade currently lists 884 cars without a single photo. The new site does not show them; the original site does.
2. **Different grouping of some body types.** The original site groups a few DealerTrade body types differently, mainly Extended Cab and Caravan.
3. **Timing.** Stock changes throughout the day, so counts taken at different moments differ by a few cars.

Once the cars without photos are added back, 6 of the 13 body types match the original site exactly, and 3 more are within 8 cars.

Count by body type

Body type	ChangeCars (new site)	Listed by DealerTrade without photos	ChangeCars + no-photo cars	Original site	Remaining difference
Double Cab Bakkie	5,245	123	5,368	5,368	0
Single Cab Bakkie	2,118	55	2,173	2,173	0
MPV	695	34	729	729	0
Motorbike	347	3	350	350	0
Panel Van	274	7	281	281	0
Station Wagon	114	1	115	115	0
Minibus	547	6	553	552	-1
Hatchback	7,415	277	7,692	7,700	+8
Sedan	1,718	31	1,749	1,753	+4
SUV	17,667	328	17,995	18,057	+62
Convertible	78	0	78	81	+3
Coupé	416	7	423	444	+21
Extended Cab	**630**	**12**	**642**	**144**	**-498**
Caravan	0	0	0	87	+87
Boat	0	0	0	0	0
Total	**37,264**	**884**	**38,148**	**37,834**	**-314**

"Remaining difference" is the original site minus (ChangeCars + no-photo cars). A positive number means the original site shows more. Original site figures were provided by the ChangeCars team; the other figures come from the DealerTrade stock feed of 31 October 2026 (38,156 cars in total).

1. Cars without photos (884 cars)

DealerTrade lists 884 cars that have no photos yet. By agreement, the new website only shows cars that have at least one photo: a listing without a picture gives buyers little to go on and makes the site look unfinished.

Nothing is lost. The new site checks DealerTrade automatically, and as soon as a dealer uploads photos for one of these cars, it appears on the new site with no manual work.

This single reason explains most of the difference: SUV 328, Hatchback 277, Double Cab Bakkie 123, Single Cab Bakkie 55, MPV 34, Sedan 31, Extended Cab 12, Coupé 7, Panel Van 7, Minibus 6, Motorbike 3, Station Wagon 1.

2. Different grouping of some body types

Extended Cab (original site 144, new site 630 + 12 without photos). DealerTrade has two separate body type codes for extended cabs: **"XCab"** with 144 cars and **"Extended Cab"** with 498 cars. The original site shows only the 144 "XCab" cars under Extended Cab, exactly matching its figure. The new site shows both codes under Extended Cab, because both describe the same kind of bakkie.

Caravan (original site 87, new site 0). None of DealerTrade's body type codes is "Caravan". The original site most likely assigns these cars from the model name or vehicle title rather than from DealerTrade's body type. On the new site, these cars appear under the body type DealerTrade gives them.

Small extras on the original site (SUV +62, Coupé +21, Hatchback +8, Sedan +4, Convertible +3). These are most likely the same effect: the original site moves some cars into these groups by name instead of by DealerTrade's code. The 498 "Extended Cab" cars the original site leaves out of Extended Cab probably account for part of these extras and the 87 caravans.

3. Timing

Dealers add, sell and edit cars all day. The new site refreshes from DealerTrade automatically every few minutes, so two counts taken even an hour apart can differ by a handful of cars. The differences of 1 to 8 cars (Minibus, Hatchback, Sedan) are within this range.

What the new site now does on every DealerTrade update

- Adds new cars as soon as DealerTrade lists them with photos.
- Updates prices, details and photos of existing cars.
- Removes cars that DealerTrade no longer lists (sold or withdrawn). Before this update, 9,722 such cars were still showing.
- Removes cars that have no photos.
- Picks 12 new featured cars at random, leaving out cars whose main photo is an "images coming soon" picture.

Decisions for ChangeCars

1. Cars without photos: keep them hidden (current) or show them with a placeholder picture, as the original site does?

2. Extended Cab grouping: keep both DealerTrade codes under Extended Cab (current), or follow the original site? If the original site is to be followed, please confirm where the 498 "Extended Cab" cars should appear.

3. Caravan: should the new site also show a Caravan group? If so, please share an example caravan listing from the original site so the same rule can be applied.